

AMAZON CUSTOMER ORDER POLICY – OFFICIAL AGENT REFERENCE

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Applicable To: All customer service agents handling order-related inquiries

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SECTION 1: GENERAL ORDER INQUIRY HANDLING

1.1 Scope of Policy

This policy governs all customer interactions regarding orders placed on Amazon marketplaces, including but not limited to order status, modifications, cancellations, returns, refunds, replacements, delivery issues, and post-delivery disputes. Agents must apply this policy uniformly across all customer segments except where noted for Prime members, business accounts, or regional variations.

1.2 Verification Requirements

Before discussing any order details, agents must verify the customer's identity using at least two of the following: order ID, registered email address, last four digits of payment method on file, or shipping postal code. If verification fails, agents must direct the customer to account recovery procedures without disclosing order information.

1.3 Order Lookup Tools

Agents must use the official Amazon Order Management System. Orders older than 365 days may have limited data availability. For orders older than 365 days, agents can only confirm shipment date, delivery date, and final status; modification or return options are not available.

1.4 Escalation Thresholds

Agents must escalate to a supervisor under these conditions: customer reports fraud or unauthorized order, order value exceeds \$5,000 USD (or local equivalent), customer requests legal action or regulatory complaint, or any threat of chargeback or dispute has been received.

SECTION 2: ORDER STATUS AND TRACKING

2.1 Definitions of Order States

Every order exists in one of the following states. Agents must use these exact terms when communicating with customers:

Pending: Customer has initiated checkout but payment has not completed. Customer can cancel freely. No fulfillment actions have begun.

Not Yet Shipped: Payment confirmed. Order assigned to a fulfillment center but not yet picked. Modifications and cancellations permitted.

Preparing for Shipment: Item picked and packed. Shipping label generated. No modifications or cancellations allowed.

Shipped: Carrier has possession. Tracking number available. Customer cannot modify or cancel.

Out for Delivery: Carrier vehicle en route to delivery address. No customer actions available.

Delivered: Carrier marks as delivered at the shipping address. Return window begins.

Delivered – Signed: Recipient signature or photo confirmation on file. Higher burden of proof for non-receipt claims.

Lost: More than 7 days past delivery estimate with no tracking updates. Triggers refund or replacement.

Damaged in Transit: Reported by carrier. Customer must wait for delivery then file claim or refuse delivery.

2.2 Tracking Information Disclosure

Agents must provide the carrier name, tracking number, and a clickable tracking URL if available. If the tracking number exists but no scans for more than 72 hours, agents must inform the customer that the carrier has not updated tracking and advise waiting an additional 24 hours before filing a lost claim.

2.3 Carrier Responsibility Separation

Amazon is not responsible for delivery delays caused by weather, natural disasters, labor strikes, government actions, or carrier sorting errors after the package leaves Amazon's fulfillment center. However, Amazon will process refunds or replacements for lost packages regardless of cause if the carrier cannot locate the package within 7 days of the last tracking event.

2.4 Signature Required Orders

For orders requiring a signature, delivery is not complete until a signature is captured. If the carrier marks as delivered without signature and the customer denies receipt, agents must process a refund or replacement immediately without requiring the customer to wait. The agent then files a carrier claim internally.

2.5 Photo Confirmation of Delivery

If the carrier provides a delivery photo, agents must review the photo before taking action. If the photo shows the package at the correct address and the customer still claims non-receipt,

agents may require a police report for orders over \$300 USD. For orders under \$300, agents may issue a one-time courtesy refund without a police report.

SECTION 3: ORDER CANCELLATION POLICY

3.1 Customer-Initiated Cancellation Rights

Customers have the right to cancel an order without penalty under the following conditions:

- The order status is "Pending" or "Not Yet Shipped."
- The request is submitted via the online cancellation tool or verbally to an agent.
- The order was placed less than 30 minutes ago for digital items (e-books, software licenses, game codes).

3.2 Cancellation Window Closure

Cancellation rights expire immediately when the order enters "Preparing for Shipment." Agents must inform customers that the order has progressed too far. The customer must receive the item and initiate a return. Agents cannot override this policy for any reason, including customer claims of accidental purchase, unless the customer is a verified vulnerable person (elderly, cognitive disability) and a supervisor approves.

3.3 Bulk Order Cancellations

For orders containing more than 10 unique items, cancellation requests must be processed item by item. If any single item has entered "Preparing for Shipment," the entire order cannot be canceled. The customer must receive all items and return unwanted items individually.

3.4 Subscription and Recurring Order Cancellation

For Subscribe & Save or recurring orders, cancellation requests received less than 24 hours before the scheduled processing time are not guaranteed. Agents must check the cutoff time for the specific subscription. If the cutoff has passed, the order processes and ships; the customer must return the item. Agents must also cancel all future scheduled deliveries upon request.

3.5 Pre-order Cancellation

Pre-orders may be canceled at any time before the release date, regardless of order status. Once the release date arrives and the order transitions to "Preparing for Shipment," standard cancellation rules apply. Agents must honor pre-order cancellation requests even if the item is in high demand.

3.6 Third-Party Seller Orders

For orders sold by third-party sellers but fulfilled by Amazon, cancellation rules are identical to Amazon-sold items. For orders fulfilled by the seller directly, agents must check the seller's cancellation policy as displayed on the product page at time of purchase. If the seller's policy is more restrictive than Amazon's, the seller's policy governs. Agents may attempt to request cancellation from the seller via internal messaging but cannot guarantee cancellation.

SECTION 4: ORDER MODIFICATION POLICY

4.1 Allowed Modifications Before Shipping

While the order status is "Not Yet Shipped," customers may request the following modifications:

- Change shipping address to a different address within the same country.
- Change payment method to another valid payment method on the account.
- Reduce quantity of any item (cannot increase quantity).
- Add gift wrap or gift message.

- Remove gift wrap or gift message.
- Change shipping speed to a faster option (additional charges apply).
- Change shipping speed to a slower option (refund of difference).

4.2 Disallowed Modifications

Agents cannot perform the following modifications under any circumstances:

- Changing the product to a different product (customer must cancel and reorder).
- Increasing quantity of any item.
- Changing shipping address to a different country.
- Adding items to an existing order.
- Changing the customer email address associated with the order.
- Changing the order date.

4.3 Address Change After Shipment

If an address change request is received after the order has shipped, agents must check if the carrier offers address correction. For UPS, FedEx, and USPS, address correction is possible within 2 hours of the first scan. After that window, the package is in transit and cannot be redirected. If address correction succeeds, the customer pays the carrier's correction fee (typically \$15–\$20 USD). If correction fails and the package is returned to Amazon, the customer must reorder and pay shipping again.

4.4 Payment Method Change After Shipment

Payment method cannot be changed after shipment. If the original payment method fails after shipment (expired card, insufficient funds), Amazon will attempt to charge the backup payment method on file. If all payment methods fail, Amazon may suspend the customer's account until payment is resolved. Agents must not apply manual charges or edit payment details post-shipment.

4.5 Gift Options Modification

Gift wrap and gift messages can be added or removed up until the moment the order enters "Preparing for Shipment." Once picked, no gift options can be changed. If gift wrap is unavailable for the customer's selected item, agents must inform the customer and offer either removal of gift wrap or cancellation of that item from the order.

SECTION 5: DELIVERY ISSUES AND RESOLUTION

5.1 Early Delivery

If an order arrives earlier than the estimated delivery date, this is not considered an issue. Customers are not entitled to any compensation or discount for early delivery. Agents must not offer any concession for early arrival.

5.2 Late Delivery Definition

An order is considered late if the customer has not received it by 11:59 PM local time on the last day of the estimated delivery window. For Prime orders with a guaranteed delivery date, the guarantee applies only to the date, not the time of day unless "by 8 PM" was explicitly stated at checkout.

5.3 Late Delivery – Prime Guarantee

For Prime members who selected a guaranteed delivery date at checkout and the order is late:

- Automatic one-month extension of Prime membership, applied within 24 hours of the missed delivery date.
- No additional cash refund, credit, or discount.
- The Prime extension is limited to one per membership year per missed guaranteed delivery.

- If the same customer experiences three missed guaranteed deliveries in a 12-month period, Amazon will issue a \$5 promotional credit for the fourth occurrence in addition to the Prime extension.

5.4 Late Delivery – Non-Prime and Standard Shipping

For non-Prime customers or Prime customers who selected standard shipping without a guarantee:

- No automatic compensation.
- If the order is more than 5 days past the estimated window, agents may refund any paid shipping fees.
- Refund of shipping fees does not require the customer to return the item.
- No additional compensation beyond shipping fee refund.

5.5 Late Delivery Exclusions

The following circumstances exempt Amazon from late delivery compensation, and agents must inform customers that no concession applies:

- Weather events that close carrier hubs (blizzards, hurricanes, floods, wildfires).
- Government-imposed curfews or travel restrictions.
- Carrier labor strikes or lockouts.
- Address errors provided by the customer.
- Delivery attempts made but customer not available.
- "Delivered" status with photo evidence even if customer claims otherwise.

5.6 Lost Package Definition and Timeline

A package is officially considered lost under the following conditions:

- No tracking scan for 7 consecutive days after the last scan.
- Tracking shows "Return to Sender" for reasons other than customer refusal.

- Carrier declares package lost in their internal system.
- Customer provides a police report for theft after delivery (see Section 5.7 for theft policy).

5.7 Stolen After Delivery Policy

If tracking shows "Delivered" and the customer claims theft:

- For orders under \$300 USD, agents may issue a one-time courtesy refund or replacement without requiring a police report, limited to one such claim per customer account per 12-month period.
- For orders over \$300 USD, agents must require a police report filed within 48 hours of delivery. The police report must specify the order ID, delivery date, and value of items.
- For customers with more than two stolen-after-delivery claims in 12 months, a police report is required for any amount and the customer is flagged for signature-on-delivery requirement for all future orders for 6 months.
- Agents must not offer refunds for theft claims on orders that were left in unsecured locations at the customer's explicit instruction (e.g., "leave at back door" notes).

5.8 Delivery to Wrong Address

If tracking shows delivery but to an address different from the customer's shipping address (confirmed via carrier geolocation or photo):

- Agents must process a full refund or free replacement immediately.
- No police report required regardless of order value.
- Agents must also file a carrier claim and request investigation.
- The customer must not be asked to check with neighbors or wait additional days.

5.9 Carrier Damage During Transit

If a package arrives with visible damage:

- Customer may refuse delivery at time of delivery. If refused, agent processes full refund including shipping.

- If customer accepts damaged package, they must file a claim within 48 hours of delivery.
- For damaged items, customer may choose replacement (if available) or full refund.
- Customer does not need to return damaged items if the damage renders the item unusable and the item value is under \$50 USD. For items over \$50, return is required at Amazon's expense.
- Agents must not require photographs of damage for items under \$100 but may ask for photographs to file carrier claims.

SECTION 6: WRONG ITEM AND MISSING ITEM POLICY

6.1 Wrong Item Received Definition

A wrong item occurs when the customer receives a product that does not match the ASIN, SKU, or product title in the order confirmation. Variations in color, size, or packaging count as wrong items if the customer selected a different option at checkout.

6.2 Wrong Item Resolution

When a customer reports receiving the wrong item:

- Agent must verify by comparing the item the customer describes against the ordered item.
- Agent must request a photograph of the received item for orders over \$100 USD.
- Customer must return the wrong item using Amazon-provided return label within 30 days.
- Upon carrier scan of the return label, agent processes a full refund or ships a replacement at no additional cost.
- Customer is not responsible for return shipping regardless of reason.
- If the wrong item is consumable (food, supplements, cosmetics) and has been opened, customer does not need to return it. Agent processes refund or replacement immediately.

6.3 Missing Item Definition

A missing item occurs when:

- The order contains multiple items but one or more items are absent from the delivered package.
- The packing slip lists an item not physically present in the package.
- The customer ordered a bundle or set but received only part of the bundle.

6.4 Missing Item Resolution

For missing item claims:

- Agent must first verify the package weight from carrier records. If the weight is consistent with the missing item absent, proceed with claim.
- For missing items valued under \$50 USD, agent may issue replacement or refund without requiring a police report or incident report.
- For missing items valued \$50–\$300 USD, agent must wait 48 hours from delivery and check if the customer has a history of missing item claims. First-time claimants receive automatic resolution. Repeated claimants (more than 2 in 12 months) require a signature for future deliveries.
- For missing items over \$300 USD, agent must require a police report and escalate to a supervisor for approval.
- If the missing item is later found by the customer, the customer must notify Amazon. No penalty applies for good-faith reporting.

6.5 Partial Shipment Not Reported as Missing

If an order is intentionally shipped in multiple packages but the customer did not realize, this is not a missing item. Agent must inform the customer of all tracking numbers and delivery dates for each package.

SECTION 7: RETURN POLICY

7.1 Standard Return Window

Most items sold and fulfilled by Amazon have a 30-day return window from the date of delivery. The window closes at 11:59 PM local time on day 30. Agents cannot extend the window for any reason except as noted in Section 7.2.

7.2 Extended Return Windows

The following categories have extended return windows:

- Amazon-branded devices (Echo, Kindle, Fire TV, Ring, Blink): 90 days from delivery.
- Baby products (car seats, strollers, monitors): 90 days from delivery.
- Holiday returns: Orders placed between November 1 and December 31 have return window extended to January 31 of the following year.
- Items purchased with a gift receipt: 90 days from delivery.

7.3 Non-Returnable Items

The following items cannot be returned for any reason unless defective or Amazon error:

- Digital products (e-books, software, game codes, music downloads) after download or access.
- Gift cards (physical and digital).
- Grocery items (perishable and non-perishable) once shipped.
- Items classified as hazardous materials (aerosols, lithium batteries, flammable liquids).
- Customized or personalized items (engraving, custom printing).
- Medical supplies (bandages, thermometers, masks) once package is opened.
- Underwear, swimwear, or intimate apparel if the hygiene seal is broken.
- Opened software or video games.

7.4 Return Condition Requirements

To receive a full refund, returned items must be in the following condition:

- Original packaging intact (unless damaged during opening).
- All accessories, manuals, cables, and included components present.
- No visible damage beyond normal handling.
- Not missing any serial numbers or identifying labels.
- For electronics, factory reset performed and no user data remaining.

If the returned item fails any of these conditions, the customer receives a partial refund of 50% of the item price. If the item is damaged beyond resale, no refund is issued and the item is discarded or returned to the customer at their expense.

7.5 Return Shipping Responsibility

- Amazon's error (wrong item, damaged, defective): Amazon pays return shipping.
- Customer changes mind (no longer wanted, found cheaper elsewhere): Customer pays return shipping, deducted from refund.
- Customer claims defective but testing shows no defect: Customer pays original shipping (if any) plus a \$5 inspection fee deducted from refund.

7.6 Return Drop-off and Pickup

Customers may return items via:

- UPS or FedEx drop-off with prepaid label (no charge for Amazon-fault returns).
- Amazon Locker or Amazon Hub Counter.
- Kohl's, Whole Foods, or Staples locations (US only).
- Scheduled UPS pickup for an additional fee (\$6.99 USD) waived for Amazon-fault returns.

7.7 Restocking Fees

Amazon charges restocking fees for the following categories when the return is due to customer change of mind:

- Electronics: 15% of item price.
- Major appliances: 20% of item price.
- Fine jewelry (over \$500 USD): 25% of item price.
- All other categories: No restocking fee.

Restocking fees are not charged if the return is due to Amazon error or product defect.

SECTION 8: REFUND POLICY AND PROCESSING

8.1 Refund Timing

Refunds are processed based on return method:

- Drop-off at UPS/FedEx/Amazon Locker: Refund initiates within 2 hours of carrier scan.
- Pickup from customer address: Refund initiates within 24 hours of pickup.
- Seller-fulfilled returns: Refund initiates after seller receives and inspects item, up to 14 days.

8.2 Refund to Original Payment Method

Refunds must be issued to the original payment method used at checkout unless:

- The original payment method is expired or closed. In this case, refund goes to Amazon gift card balance.
- The customer requests an Amazon gift card refund explicitly. Agents may honor this request.
- The order was paid with multiple payment methods (e.g., gift card + credit card). Refund applies first to gift card balance, then to credit card.

8.3 Partial Refunds

Partial refunds are issued in the following scenarios:

- Item returned in used condition: 50% of item price refunded.
- Missing accessories or manuals: Amount equal to replacement cost of missing items deducted.
- Return initiated after return window but within 14 additional days: 80% of item price.
- Return initiated more than 44 days after delivery: No refund.

8.4 Refund for Never Received Item

If an order never shows "Delivered" and is officially lost:

- Full refund including shipping charges.
- Refund initiates immediately without waiting for return (no item to return).
- Customer receives refund within 3–5 business days for credit cards, within 24 hours for Amazon gift card balance.

8.5 Refund for Cancelled Order

If an order is cancelled before shipping:

- No charge is ever made. If a temporary authorization exists, it drops off automatically within 7 days.
- If a charge was erroneously posted (system error), agent must process a full refund immediately and escalate to technical team.

8.6 Dispute and Chargeback Handling

If a customer initiates a chargeback with their bank instead of contacting Amazon:

- Agent must not promise resolution. The dispute is handled by Amazon's payments team.
- Agent must ask the customer to withdraw the chargeback if Amazon can resolve the issue directly.

- If the customer refuses to withdraw, agent must provide the customer with Amazon's chargeback rebuttal documentation.
- Agents do not have authority to refund an order that is in active chargeback status.

SECTION 9: REPLACEMENT POLICY

9.1 Replacement vs. Refund

Customers may choose a replacement instead of a refund for:

- Wrong item received.
- Damaged item received.
- Defective item received.
- Missing item from a multi-item order.

Replacement is not available for:

- Customer change of mind.
- Items that are out of stock or discontinued.
- Items purchased from third-party sellers that do not offer replacements.

9.2 Replacement Shipping Speed

Replacements ship at the same speed as the original order at no additional cost. If the original order used expedited shipping, the replacement also uses expedited shipping. Agents cannot upgrade replacement shipping speed unless the original was delayed due to Amazon error.

9.3 Return Requirement for Replacement

For replacements due to Amazon error, the customer must return the original item using the provided label. If the customer does not return the original item within 30 days of receiving the replacement, Amazon charges the customer's payment method for the full price of the replacement item.

9.4 Defective Item Replacement

For defective items, the customer may request a replacement without returning the original if:

- The item is a consumable (food, supplements) and opened.
- The item is a hygiene product (toothbrush, razor) and used.
- The item is under \$25 USD and return shipping would exceed the item's value.

Agent discretion applies for items between \$25 and \$50 USD.

SECTION 10: THIRD-PARTY SELLER ORDERS

10.1 Seller Fulfilled vs. Amazon Fulfilled

For orders where the seller fulfills their own inventory:

- Amazon agents cannot modify, cancel, or change the order after purchase.
- Agents must contact the seller on the customer's behalf via the Buyer-Seller Messaging system.
- Sellers have 48 hours to respond. If no response, Amazon may issue an A-to-Z Guarantee refund.

10.2 A-to-Z Guarantee Claims

Customers may file an A-to-Z claim when:

- Item not received within 3 days of maximum estimated delivery date.
- Item received is damaged, defective, or materially different.
- Seller refuses return or refund despite policy.
- Seller does not respond to customer messages within 48 hours.

10.3 A-to-Z Decision Timeline

Once a claim is filed:

- Seller has 7 days to respond or resolve.
- If no resolution, Amazon reviews the claim within 7 days.
- Amazon decides in favor of the customer if the customer provides reasonable evidence (photos, tracking, messages).
- Amazon funds the refund from the seller's account or from Amazon's guarantee fund.

10.4 International Seller Orders

For orders shipped from outside the customer's country:

- Return shipping costs are the seller's responsibility for Amazon-fault returns.
- Customer pays return shipping for change-of-mind returns.
- Customs duties and taxes paid at import are not refunded by Amazon. Customer must contact their local customs agency.

SECTION 11: EXCEPTIONS AND ESCALATIONS

11.1 Supervisor Escalation Required

Agents must escalate to a supervisor without attempting resolution in these cases:

- Customer threatens legal action, arbitration, or regulatory complaint (FTC, BBB, Attorney General).
- Customer reports identity theft or unauthorized account access affecting orders.
- Order value exceeds \$10,000 USD.
- Customer is a known serial return abuser (more than 20 returns in 30 days) and is requesting another return.
- Item is a recalled product and customer has not been notified.
- Customer requests refund for an order older than 12 months.

11.2 Customer Abusive Behavior

If a customer uses profanity, threats, discriminatory language, or repeated harassment:

- Agent must warn the customer once: "I am here to help, but I cannot continue if you use that language."
- If behavior continues, agent may terminate the interaction and document the account.
- No refund or replacement is processed for an interaction that was terminated due to abuse.
- Supervisor may place the customer in a "chat-only" or "email-only" support channel for 30 days.

11.3 Compassionate Exceptions

Agents may, with supervisor approval, grant exceptions to return windows or refund policies in cases of:

- Death of the customer or immediate family member (death certificate required).
- Serious illness or hospitalization (documentation required).
- Natural disaster destroying the customer's home (FEMA or insurance documentation).
- Military deployment (deployment orders required).

Compassionate exceptions are limited to one per customer per lifetime.

11.4 Policy Override Authority

No agent has authority to override any policy in this document without written approval from a Tier 3 support manager. Unauthorized overrides result in corrective action including retraining, suspension, or termination.

SECTION 12: RECORDING AND DOCUMENTATION

12.1 Required Documentation for Each Interaction

Agents must document the following for every customer interaction:

- Order ID and customer account ID.
- Timestamp of interaction start and end.
- Reason for contact selected from the standard reason code list.
- Policy sections applied to the resolution.
- Any concessions granted (refund, replacement, credit) with dollar amounts.
- Supervisor approval ID if escalation occurred.

12.2 Customer Notes

Agents must add clear, factual notes to the customer's account including:

- Summary of the customer's statement.
- Actions taken by the agent.
- Any promises made to the customer (shipping dates, follow-up times).
- Warnings issued for abusive behavior or policy violations.

12.3 Retention Period

All interaction records and account notes are retained for 7 years from the date of the interaction. Orders older than 7 years are purged and cannot be referenced for any claim or dispute.

SECTION 13: COMPLIANCE AND LIABILITY

13.1 Regulatory Compliance

Agents must comply with all applicable consumer protection laws including but not limited to:

- FTC Mail, Internet, or Telephone Order Merchandise Rule (MTOR): Orders must ship within the promised time or customer must be notified and given cancellation option.
- EU Consumer Rights Directive: 14-day withdrawal period for distance sales.
- UK Consumer Rights Act 2015: Goods must be of satisfactory quality, fit for purpose, and as described.
- California Automatic Renewal Law: Clear disclosure and easy cancellation for subscription orders.

13.2 Amazon Not Liable For

Amazon is not liable and agents must not accept liability for:

- Consequential damages (lost profits, lost time, emotional distress).
- Third-party seller conduct beyond the A-to-Z Guarantee.
- Carrier conduct after delivery scan.
- Customer errors in address, payment, or selection.
- Price changes after purchase.

13.3 Agent Personal Liability

Agents are not personally liable for any resolution made in good faith following this policy. Agents who knowingly violate policy to grant unauthorized concessions may be subject to employment action but not personal financial liability.

SECTION 14: POLICY UPDATES AND REVIEW

14.1 Review Cycle

This policy is reviewed quarterly by the Customer Service Policy Committee. Updates are published on the first business day of January, April, July, and October.

14.2 Emergency Changes

Critical policy changes (security, fraud, legal requirements) may be implemented with 24 hours' notice via mandatory agent training.

14.3 Version Control

Agents must reference the version number at the beginning of every interaction. The current version is displayed in the agent knowledge base. Outdated printed copies are invalid.

APPENDIX A: ORDER STATUS QUICK REFERENCE TABLE

Status	Cancellation Allowed	Modification Allowed	Refund Available	Return Required
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
Pending	Yes	Yes	No	N/A

Not Yet Shipped	Yes	Yes	No	N/A	
Preparing for Shipment	No	No	No	N/A	
Shipped	No	No	No	N/A	
Delivered	No	No	Yes	Yes (if refund requested)	
Lost	No	No	Yes	No	

APPENDIX B: CONCESSION AUTHORITY LIMITS

Agent Level	Maximum Refund Without Escalation	Maximum Replacement Value	Maximum Promotional Credit	
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Tier 1	\$50 USD	\$100 USD	\$10 USD	
Tier 2	\$200 USD	\$500 USD	\$25 USD	
Tier 3	\$500 USD	\$1,000 USD	\$50 USD	
Supervisor	Unlimited	Unlimited	\$100 USD	

END OF POLICY DOCUMENT